

Netflix fixes

Netflix tweaks that are worth it

Improve your Netflix experience

Jayesh Shinde | editor@digit.in

Most Netflix advice stops at "turn off autoplay." Fine, but if you've been subscribed for years, you've probably already done that, right? So we've put together a bunch of slightly more unknown Netflix tweaks, and a few fixes that live on your television or PC's browser rather than on Netflix at all.

Some of these take ten seconds, others take a few minutes. But all of them change something you'll actually notice while firing up Netflix next time.

1) Find your Netflix video resolution

Netflix silently downgrades your stream (under certain circumstances) without telling you about it. So before you start fiddling with quality settings, check what you're really receiving, thanks to a hidden debug overlay for exactly this.

This setting shows your live bitrate, resolution, framerate, buffer size and which CDN you're pulling from. If it says 1080p while you're paying for Premium, you now know the problem is your device, not your settings.

How to do it:

1. Open Netflix in a browser on your computer and start by playing anything you want.
2. Press Ctrl + Shift + Alt + D (on Mac, use Option instead of Alt).
3. Read the "Playing bitrate" and resolution lines in the overlay.
4. Press the same combination again to dismiss it.

One note for anyone who remembers the old Ctrl + Shift + Alt + S bitrate-picker: Netflix disabled that for regular accounts back in winter 2018. The code still exists in the player, but it's gated behind a test-account check.

2) Kill motion smoothing on your TV, not in Netflix

If films look oddly fluid and cheap – like a daytime soap shot on video – that's motion interpolation, and it's all down to your TV's factory setting. Your TV is inventing frames between the real ones, and 24 fps cinema is exactly the type of content it ruins.

The fastest fix is Filmmaker Mode, an industry-standard preset that switches off motion smoothing, noise reduction and sharpening in one go, and activates automatically when the set detects a film. Hisense, LG, Panasonic, Philips, Samsung, TCL and Vizio all support it.

How to do it:

1. Press the settings or home button on your TV remote and open the Picture Mode.
2. Select Filmmaker Mode if it's listed. You're done.
3. If it isn't, hunt for the motion setting under Picture → Advanced. It's called Motionflow on Sony, TruMotion on LG, Auto Motion Plus on Samsung, and MEMC or Action Smoothing on TCL.
4. Set it to Off.

Sony owners, read this: Sony doesn't adopt Filmmaker Mode. Set Motionflow to Off and pick a Cinema or Professional preset instead. Some LG, Panasonic and Sony sets also carry the Netflix Calibrated Mode, which does exactly the same job but only for Netflix content.

3) Understand where 4K works

Setting playback quality to High